

Vibe Print — Setup

Enable, sign in, and configure Vibe Print on your Vibe Appliance.

Vibe Appliance setup guide · built 2026-08-30 · generated from the app's manifest · KisaesDevLab/Vibe-Appliance

1. What this app is

LAN print routing gateway: other Vibe apps POST a job, it renders and routes to thermal, label, and office printers.

App id (slug)	vibe-printer
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2. Before you enable it

- The appliance itself must be installed and healthy — see the **Vibe Appliance setup guide** first if you haven't done that yet.
- Each running app uses memory. Two or three apps fit a 2 GB server; for all of them plan on 4 GB or more.
- If the card shows an image not published badge, the app's build isn't available yet — the Enable button stays off until it is.

3. Enable the app

1. Open the admin console and scroll to **Apps**.
2. On the **Vibe Print** card, click **Enable**.
3. Watch the badge: `not-installed` → `enabling...` → `running`. This usually takes a minute or two (first enable pulls the app's images).

Behind the button, the appliance creates the app's database and a restricted database user, writes its configuration file from a template, starts its containers, and only reports **running** once the app's own health check answers that it is fully ready. If enabling fails, the card shows the error with a recovery hint — fix the cause and click Enable again; re-running is always safe.

4. Open it and sign in

Domain mode	<code>https://print.<your-domain>/</code> — this app is served at the root of its own subdomain (it cannot be path-mounted). The appliance provisions the DNS/tunnel route automatically when you enable it.
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LAN / Tailscale	Use the emergency port (next section) — a root-served app has no path URL on the shared hostname.
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The exact live URL for your install is always shown on this app's card in the admin console — use that if in doubt.

Open the app URL. The first-login credentials are shown in the admin console under **First-login info**.

5. Setup on Windows

There is nothing to install on Windows for this app — it runs on the appliance server, and you use it from a browser (Microsoft Edge or Chrome, as your firm prefers). What follows is the Windows side of reaching it in each mode.

- **Domain mode:** just open the URL from the previous section. The certificate is real, so there is nothing to click through.
- **LAN mode:** recent Windows 10 and 11 resolve `<host>.local` addresses out of the box, but some office networks and VPN clients block that discovery traffic. If the `.local` address doesn't load, use the server's IP address instead: `http://<server-ip>:5194/` (this app's LAN address is its emergency port). The exact working URL is always shown on this app's card in the admin console.
- **Tailscale mode:** install the Tailscale app for Windows from `tailscale.com/download`, sign in to the firm's tailnet, and the tailnet URL from the section above works. The Tailscale icon in the system tray shows whether you're connected.
- **Bookmark it:** once the right URL loads, save it as a browser favorite (Ctrl+D) — or let your IT person pin it via a browser shortcut on each staff desktop.

6. Settings

Everything required (database, cache, secrets, URLs) is generated automatically when you enable the app. The settings below are the ones you may need to fill in yourself. Find them in the admin console under **Settings**, on the tab named in the left column.

Network tab

SETTING	WHAT TO ENTER
Subdomain	The <code><subdomain></code> in <code><subdomain>.<your-domain></code> for this app. Leave blank to use the built-in default. Lowercase letters, digits, and dashes; no dots. Saving re-renders routing and re-provisions the Cloudflare Tunnel; the app briefly restarts.

Compliance tab

SETTING	WHAT TO ENTER
Keep printed payloads	Off keeps only a content hash after a job prints - safer, and the appliance default. On keeps the full rendered payload so you can inspect or reprint it.
Job retention (days)	How long finished print jobs stay in the Jobs tab before they are pruned.
Audit retention (days)	How long the tamper-evident audit log is kept. Default 365. Check your own retention policy before shortening this.

Application tab

SETTING	WHAT TO ENTER
Rate limit (requests/minute)	Per-caller request ceiling. Default 120. A busy point-of-sale integration may need more.

Time & Logging tab

SETTING	WHAT TO ENTER
Time zone (override)	Inherited from appliance. Override only if the printers serve a location in a different zone than the host.

7. Updates and rollback

- When a newer build is available, the card shows an **update available** badge. Click **Update**.
- Before updating, the appliance takes a database backup automatically. If the updated app fails its health check, it is rolled back to the previous version — and the **Roll back** button lets you do the same by hand.
- Updates are never automatic; nothing changes until you click.

8. If something goes wrong

- **Run the doctor first.** Admin console → **Doctor** → Run (or `sudo vibe doctor` on the server). It names the failing check and the fix.
- **Read the card.** Errors on the app card include a recovery hint; the output panel under the buttons shows the last action's log.
- **Emergency access.** If the normal URL is down but the app itself is running, `http://<server-ip>:5194/` reaches it directly, bypassing the web front end. Plain HTTP — use it from the LAN or Tailscale only, for getting back on your feet, not for daily work. (The **ONLY** way in on LAN/Tailscale (rootServedOnly: no path mount). It is also the **RIGHT** way in on a LAN: the printers this gateway talks to are on that same network.)

- **Disable / Enable** from the card restarts the app cleanly. Disabling never deletes data.
- Still stuck? `docs/TROUBLESHOOTING.md` in the appliance repository is keyed by symptom.